1. A minister can participate in the proceedings of a House, of which he/she is not a member. In other words, a minister belonging to the Lok Sabha can participate in the proceedings of the Rajya Sabha and vice-versa.

2. A minister, who is not a member of either House, can participate in the proceedings of both the Houses. It should be noted here that a person can remain a minister for six months, without being a member of either House of Parliament.

 **Lame-duck Session**

It refers to the last session of the preceding Lok Sabha, after a new Lok Sabha has been elected. Those members of the preceding Lok Sabha who could not get re-elected to the new Lok Sabha are called lame-ducks.

During the years 1957 and 1962 when general elections to Lok Sabha were held, in addition to three sessions of the new Lok Sabha, one session each of the preceding Lok Sabha was also held after elections to new Lok Sabha had taken place and results thereof had been announced, but before the new Lok Sabha was duly constituted. These were popularly known as "lame-duck sessions". The purpose of these sessions was to pass the Vote on Account to enable the government to carry on till the new Lok Sabha was constituted. However, there was no lame-duck session of the Third Lok Sabha as the Fourth Lok Sabha was constituted soon after the result of the Fourth General Elections had been announced. The Vote on Account was passed in the first session of the new Lok Sabha[13c].

TYPES OF MAJORITY

The following four types of majority are required to determine the various matters in the Parliament:

1. Simple Majority

It is a majority of the members present and voting in the House. It is also known as ordinary majority or functional majority or working majority. Article 100 of the Constitution states that except as otherwise provided in this Constitution, all questions at any sitting of either House or joint sitting of the Houses shall be determined by a majority of votes of the members present and voting. This means that the simple majority is the general rule prescribed by the Constitution for the determination of questions in the Parliament. This type of majority is required in the following cases:

(a) Passing of the ordinary bills, money bills and financial bills.

(b) Passing of the Adjournment Motion, No-Confidence Motion, Confidence Motion, Censure Motion and Motion of Thanks.

(c) Removal of the Vice-President in the Lok Sabha (Article 67).

(d) Approval of the imposition of the President's Rule (Article 356).

(e) Approval of the proclamation of financial emergency (Article 360).

(f) Election of the Speaker and the Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha (Article 93).

(g) Election of the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha (Article 89).